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! Your PC is most likely infected by a virus. There are many worms and viruses that disable the registry editor and task manager. The only easy solution is to use an antivirus to remove it. If the games you mentioned require some Visual C++ runtimes, you'll have to download those and install them if they are corrupted.

Data recovery query

I have an Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 250 GB hard drive and 2 GB RAM. My hard drive crashed and I recovered data using Stellar Phoenix. I am a MCA student and this data is very precious to me. For some reason, file recovered with formats such as JPG, PDF, RAR and ZIP aren't opening. It says unsupported type or version. Even EXE files run but it show a command prompt window and closes instantaneously. I checked the properties for the files but everything seems okay. I tried different operating systems such as Windows XP, Windows Vista and Linux. I also tried different registry and system diagnostic tools but nothing seems to work.

Vikram Paliwal

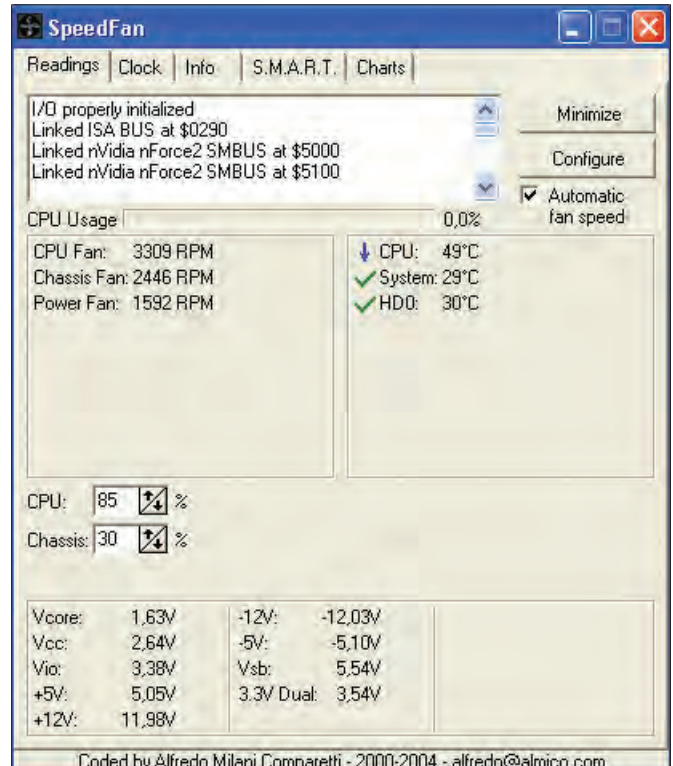
! Data recovery isn't perfect every single time. So while software might be able to recover most of the data, there are always bits of pieces of the files that aren't intact. This might be fine for documents but executables and archives won't open with the least bit of corruption of missing data. The bad news is that it might not be possible to recover the files accurately.

You could try contacting Stellar or some of the other physically data recovery services. They might be able to recover data from the drive but remember that it could be very expensive.

Windows XP problems

My PC configuration is:
Intel Core 2 Duo E4600
Gigabyte S2C 945 GCM motherboard
2 GB DDR2 RAM
160 GB Hitachi HDD
Samsung DVD writer
Intex cabinet with 450 W SMPS
Viewsonic 19-inch TFT with only D-Sub connector

I have Windows Vista and XP installed on my system.



Speedfan has a built-in drive health feature that displays basic statistics about the drive

1. Whenever I boot in XP, Windows runs fine but when I boot into Windows Vista, the monitor goes blank randomly for

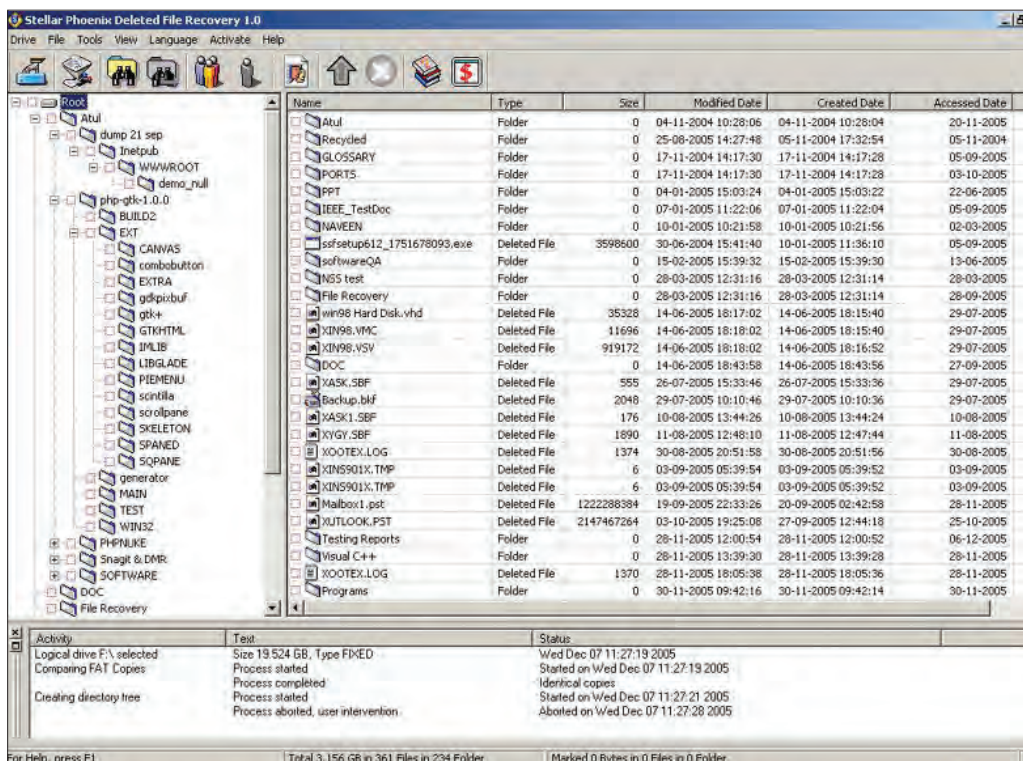
a fraction of a second but otherwise, it works fine.

2. My HDD activity light flickers without any program running and its operation is noisy too. Also my operating system fails every now and then.

3. Is a 450 watts power supply enough if I add one more hard drive and a graphics card? Also, suggest a mid-range graphics card for my configuration.

Paramjit Saggu
Chandigarh

! Windows normally flashes the display just before it boots into the desktop. It shouldn't cause any serious problems. The hard drive LED flickering could be because of a highly fragmented hard drive. Try defragging the drive sometime. If the hard drive is really old, it could be some issue with the drive. Try running a diagnostic tool or use Speedfan's internal drive diagnosing feature. The 450W PSU will run an additional hard drive easily. Whether it runs the graphics card depends on the kind of card itself. A basic entry-level card like a GeForce 8400GS



Stellar Phoenix is a general data recovery software